



The Monaco Glacier

An immense glacier on Spitsbergen, the largest island of the Svalbard archipelago

Spitsbergen, in northern Norway, is around 1,150 miles (1,850 km) from the North Pole, and about 80 percent of it is covered in glaciers. The Monaco Glacier, situated on an area of the island called Haakon VII Land, is one of the largest. The glacier discharges copious amounts of ice into a long fjord, Liefdefjord, at its front end.

A princely river of ice

Some 25 miles (40 km) long, the glacier is named after Prince Albert I of Monaco, a pioneering polar explorer of the early 20th century, who organized the first expeditions to explore and map the glacier. According to mapping studies, the glacier has retreated by more than 2 miles (3 km) in the last 50 years. Ringed seals, bearded seals, various seabird species, and polar bears are the main inhabitants of the neighboring ice floes, coasts, and islands.



△ SEA OF ICE

Ice calving off the Monaco and other glaciers nearby is the source of imposing, ship-sized icebergs that float in the middle of Liefdefjord.

▷ FROZEN WALL

A flock of kittiwakes feed in front of the Monaco Glacier's enormous terminal wall, which is more than 165 ft (50 m) high and 2 miles (4 km) wide.



The **thundering sound** of ice breaking off the glacier can be heard for **tens of miles** around